

Economics & Finance Workshop

Exit Survey Results

An independent summary of student feedback

Prepared for: Yale Pathways to Arts & Humanities Summer Scholars Program | Instructor: Tudor Schlanger
Summer 2026 | $n = 12$ students | anonymous exit survey

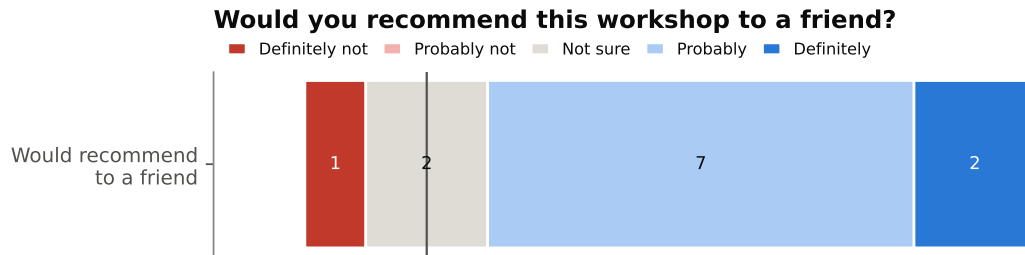


Figure 1: Willingness to recommend the workshop to a friend (counts of 12).

1. Who we heard from

Twelve students completed the anonymous exit survey. The group was split across grades 9–11, and most arrived with little or no formal economics background—so the gains below start from a near-beginner baseline.

Characteristic	Most common response (mode)	Respondents
Grade (this fall)	Grade 10	6 of 12
Prior econ / finance exposure	A little, informally	5 of 12
Prior interest (1–5)	Somewhat interested = 3	4 of 12

Table 1: Respondent profile ($n = 12$): most common response to each question.

2. What worked best

2.1 Teaching was rated highly

Every teaching statement drew majority agreement. Students were most positive about the **open, question-friendly classroom** and **clear explanations**—the two items where 92% agreed or strongly agreed.

2.2 Attitudes shifted toward relevance

The workshop moved the needle most on **relevance**: three-quarters of students left seeing economics as more connected to daily life and to how governments make policy.

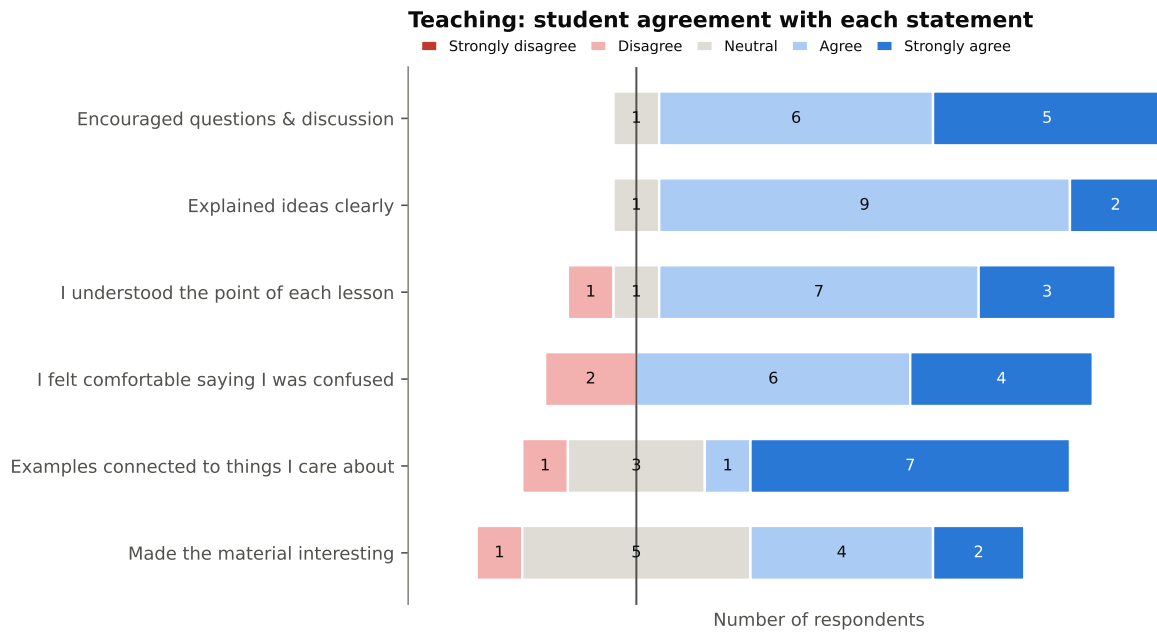


Figure 2: Agreement with each teaching statement (counts of 12 respondents), best-rated at top.

Teaching statement	Mean (1–5)	% Agree (4–5)
Encouraged questions & discussion	4.33	92%
Examples connected to things I care about	4.17	67%
Explained ideas clearly	4.08	92%
I understood the point of each lesson	4.00	83%
I felt comfortable saying I was confused	4.00	83%
Made the material interesting	3.58	50%
Overall	4.03	

Table 2: Teaching ratings, highest mean first.

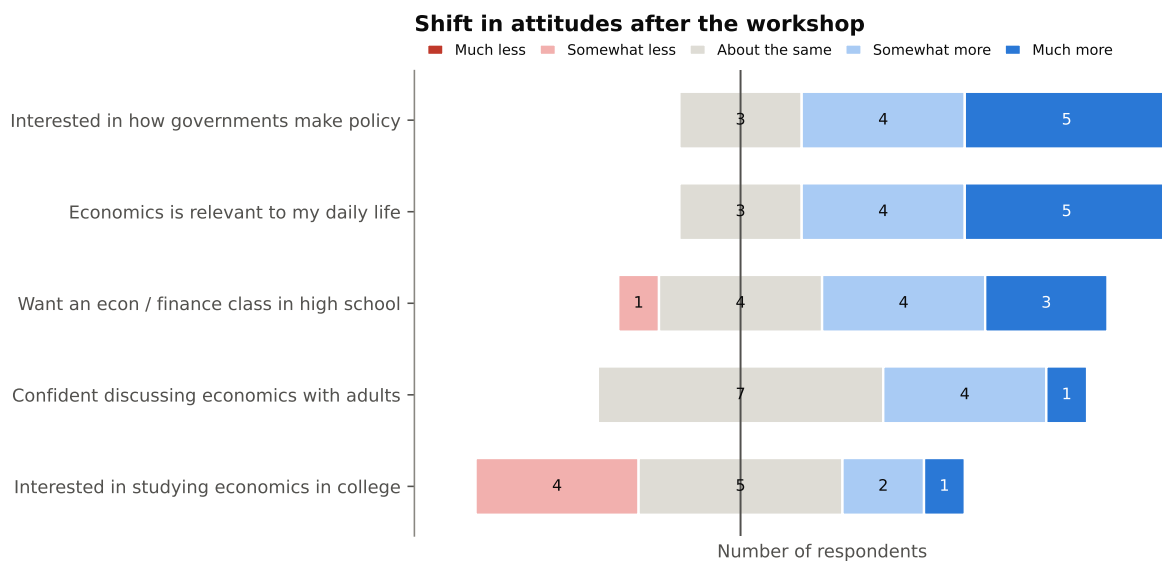


Figure 3: Self-reported change in attitudes since before the workshop (counts of 12).

Since the workshop, I feel...	Mean (1–5)	% “More” (4–5)
Economics is relevant to my daily life	4.17	75%
Interested in how governments make policy	4.17	75%
Want an econ / finance class in high school	3.75	58%
Confident discussing economics with adults	3.50	42%
Interested in studying economics in college	3.00	25%

Table 3: Attitude shift (5 = much more than before).

2.3 Day 1 hooked them; Day 5 was most useful

Day 1 (Economic Decision-Making) was the standout opener, marked “interesting” by two-thirds of students. The financial-literacy content on Day 5—and the trade material on Day 4—were most often marked “useful outside school.” Reassuringly, no single day was widely flagged as hard.

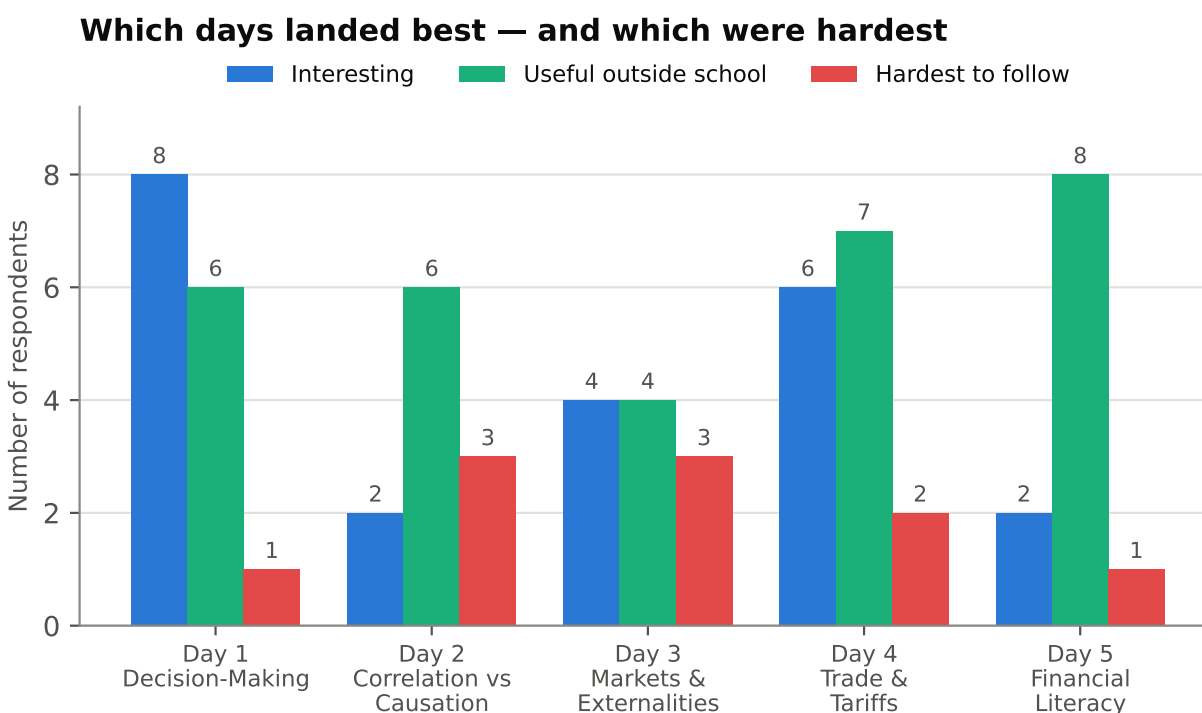


Figure 4: Votes per day for interesting, useful, and hardest to follow. Students marked every day that applied in each column, not a single choice.

2.4 Learning by doing (and by news)

When asked which ways of learning helped most, students favored **real-world news examples, discussion, and games and simulations** over slides—a clear signal about where to invest classroom time.

2.5 Most would recommend it

Three-quarters of students (9 of 12) would “probably” or “definitely” recommend the workshop (see the headline chart on page 1). The single “definitely not” came from a student who noted they had not chosen to enroll—an enrollment-fit issue rather than a comment on the teaching.

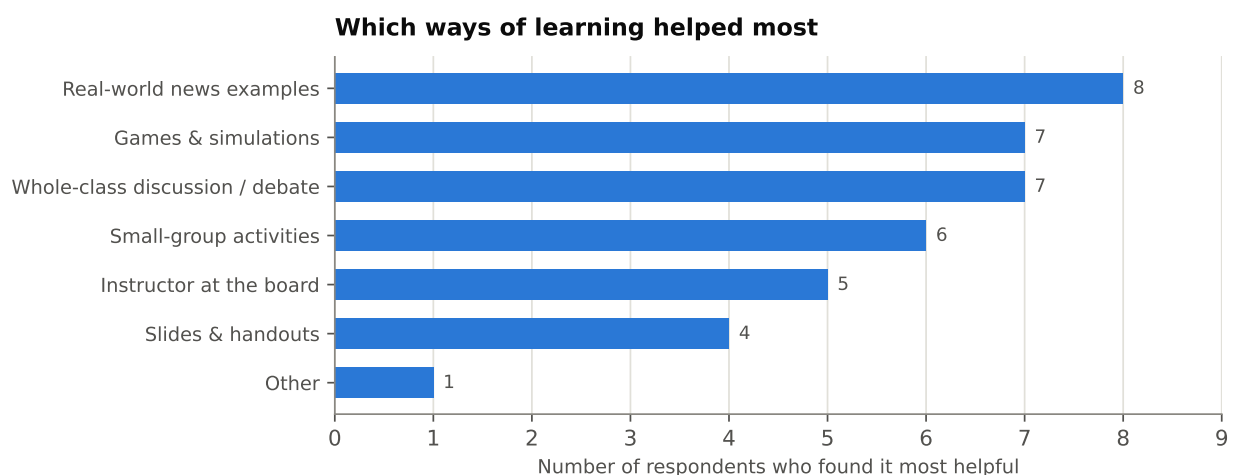


Figure 5: Ways of learning students found most helpful (each could choose up to two; several chose more).

3. Where to improve

- 1. Make it *feel* as interesting as it is useful.** “Made the material interesting” was the only teaching item below 4.0 (mean 3.58; just 50% agreed, with 5 students neutral). The open feedback points the same way: students asked for more “fun and interactive” and “hands-on” lessons.
- 2. Break hard concepts into small gradual steps.** Day 2 (Correlation vs. Causation) and Day 3 (Markets & Externalities) were each flagged “hardest to follow” by 3 students—the most of any days. Extra worked examples and mid-lesson checks would help.
- 3. Build confidence and the college bridge.** Confidence discussing economics with adults barely moved (58% “about the same”), and interest in *studying economics in college* was the weakest outcome (25% up; 4 students dipped). The workshop built relevance far more than it built a sense of “this could be my path.”
- 4. Give them concrete tools.** The most specific request was practical: how to actually invest. Adding a short, concrete “how to start investing” toolkit would meet real demand.

4. In students’ own words

“This was a really interesting lesson... This class was important to me because I’m getting into the financial world. I liked it, thank you so much.” — *recommended: definitely*

“The small-group activities helped motivate me to think with different perspectives. Sharing out ideas was also helpful.” — *recommended: definitely*

“This class was much more interesting than I had originally anticipated—great job!” — *recommended: probably*

Constructive:

“I think more hands-on aspects would make this class more engaging, such as the candy example.” — *recommended: probably*

“It would be nice to make it more fun and interactive.” — *recommended: not sure*

5. Recommendations

1. **Lead with what already works:** shift more time into games, simulations, and real-world news, and convert board-time into hands-on activities—these are exactly the modes students rated most helpful.
2. **Add a concrete investing segment** (a short, practical “how to start” toolkit) to satisfy the clearest student request.
3. **Break hard concepts into small gradual steps on Days 2–3**, with additional worked examples and quick comprehension checks to lower the difficulty spikes.
4. **Grow confidence through student voice:** more student-led discussion and brief share-outs, so students practice talking economics aloud.
5. **Bridge to “what’s next”:** a short segment on econ/finance pathways (courses, careers) to lift interest in studying the subject further.

Method note. Findings are based on 12 anonymous two-page exit surveys collected on the final day. Each form was transcribed and independently spot-checked; percentages are of 12 respondents and Likert items are coded 1–5. With a small sample, results are best read as directional signals rather than precise estimates.